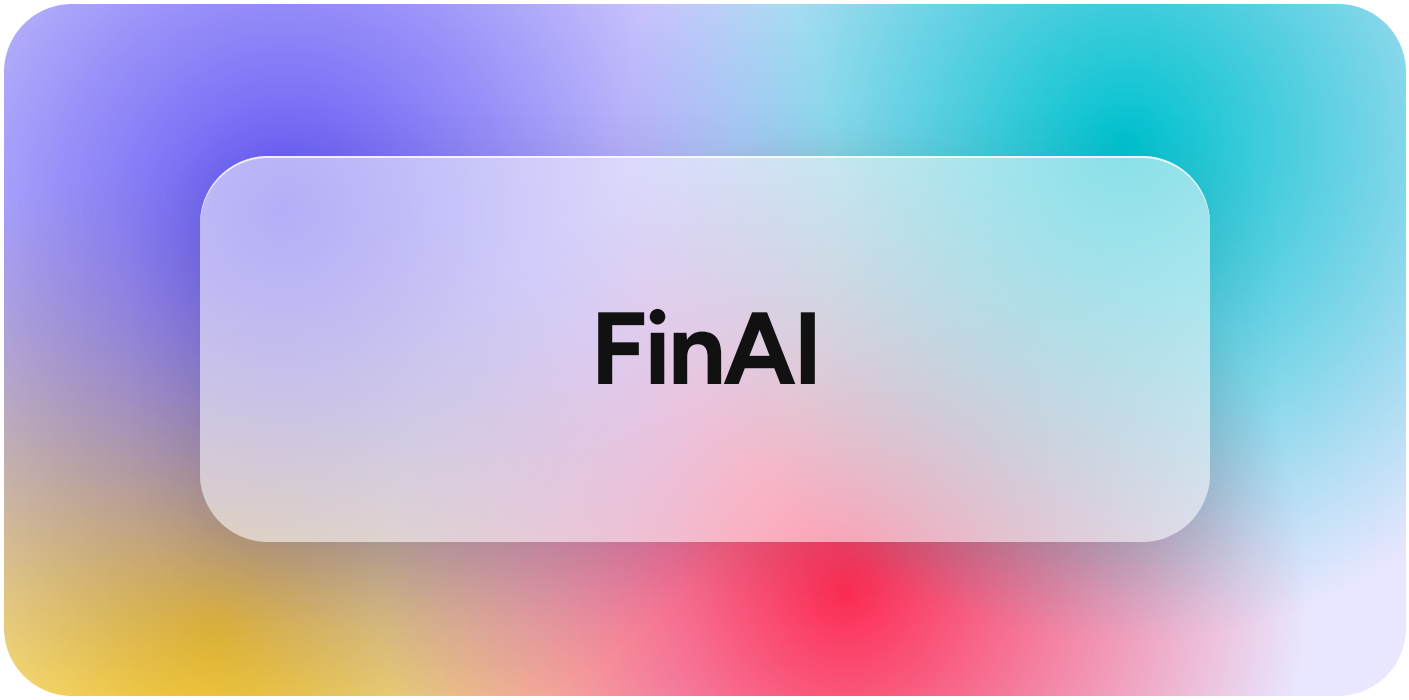
FINAI · DESIGN SYSTEM · V1.0

A calm, Apple-grade ledger.

The design system behind FinAI's look and feel: the research, the decisions, every token and every component, and how they were applied to the product.



Foundation
Apple iOS 26 Human Interface Guidelines, UIKit, iOS & iPadOS 26 Figma kit

Typography
Figtree + Inter, a Wealthsimple-style pairing on Apple's Dynamic Type scale

Shipped in
apps/web/src/index.css (tokens) and styles/components.css (components). October 2026

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How to read this document. Every color swatch, type sample and component specimen here is rendered by the product's own stylesheets. Nothing was redrawn. If the CSS changes, rebuild this PDF with `python3 docs/design-system/build.py` and the document updates with it.

01

Research & sources

The system started with three primary sources and one reference brand:

Apple Human Interface Guidelines

Read from Apple's own documentation data: Color, Typography, Materials, Layout, Dark Mode, Accessibility, Motion, Buttons, Lists & tables, Sheets, Toggles, Segmented controls, Tab bars, Sidebars, Text fields, Menus, Alerts, SF Symbols, Writing, Inclusion and Charting data. The system colors and type tables come from the HIG's specification tables (June 2025 iOS 26 values, updated Dec 2025 for Liquid Glass).

UIKit documentation

The semantic color API names (`label`, `secondaryLabel`, `systemGroupedBackground`, `systemFill`, `separator`…) became FinAI's token names, so a designer can say "secondary label" and mean exactly one thing.

iOS & iPadOS 26 Figma kit

Apple's community kit, copied into the team's drafts and read through the Figma API: Colors (node 0:1746), Materials (215:105157), Buttons (507:24673), Lists (507:24675), Segmented controls (507:24683) and Sidebars (507:26013). It supplied the iOS 26 label, separator and background values and the Liquid Glass recipes.

Wealthsimple (typography reference)

wealthsimple.com uses The Future (headings), Wealthsimple Sans (interface) and Tiempos Text (editorial), all commercial or proprietary. FinAI uses the closest open equivalents:

Figtree

for display and

Inter

for text.

Apple's WWDC design sessions (*Designing Fluid Interfaces*, *The Details of UI Typography*, *Principles of Great Design*) informed the motion, tracking and principle sections.

02

Design system thinking

FinAI's previous look ("Night Ledger") had a strong personality but only a handful of loosely named colors, and those names did double duty: `--accent` was both a button fill and a text color, and `--border` was both a hairline and a field outline. The redesign replaces that with a **three-tier token architecture**. Each tier only talks to the one below it:

1 · Primitives

Raw values Apple publishes: 12 system colors, their increased-contrast twins and six grays (`--sys-indigo`, `--sys-green-ic`, `--sys-gray-3`). Components never use these directly.

2 · Semantic

What a value means: `--bg-grouped`, `--label-secondary`, `--fill-tertiary`, `--separator`, `--tint-fill` vs `--tint-text`, `--status-positive`, `--glass-bg`, `--type-headline`, `--spring`.

3 · App aliases

The short names the components already used (`--bg`, `--surface`, `--text`, `--accent`, `--outflow`), now pointing at the semantic tier. The whole product changed without rewriting 190 inline styles.

Decisions that shaped the system

Decision	Why
Grouped, card-based structure (`#F2F2F7` page, white sections)	A finance app is lists of accounts and transactions. Apple's inset-grouped pattern (Settings, Wallet) is the most familiar way to scan grouped data, and it separates sections with background steps instead of borders.
systemIndigo as the accent	Distinctive for a money product, and clearly different from the green used for money in. Split into `--tint-fill` (keeps the light indigo in dark mode so white labels stay ≥ 4.5:1) and `--tint-text` (the brighter dark-mode indigo for text and icons).
Color carries meaning only	Following Apple Wallet: expenses read in the primary label color; **green = money in**, **red = destructive or below zero**. The minus sign carries direction, so color is never the only signal (HIG: Inclusive color).
Accessible secondary label	Apple's 60%-alpha secondary label is about 3.5:1 on white, below the 4.5:1 HIG minimum for text up to 17pt. FinAI uses Apple's opaque increased-contrast gray (`#6C6C70` / `#AEAEB2`) so footnotes and dates pass everywhere.
Liquid Glass only in the control layer	HIG: "Don't use Liquid Glass in the content layer." The sidebar, phone drawer, back button, menu button and popovers float in glass; cards, lists and fields stay solid.
Capsules for controls, concentric radii for containers	iOS 26 makes buttons, chips and search bars capsules. Containers nest their radii concentrically (inner radius = outer radius − padding), so the corners never fight.
Web-safe Apple typography	SF Pro can't be licensed for the web. Figtree and Inter follow Apple's Dynamic Type sizes, leading and size-specific tracking, and amounts use tabular figures instead of a monospace font.

03

Principles

Apple's eight principles, translated into rules a FinAI designer can apply on a Tuesday afternoon.

Purpose

Every screen answers one money question: how much do I have, where did it go, what needs attention. Anything that doesn't serve that answer doesn't ship.

Agency

People stay in control: imports always end on a review step, deletions offer Archive before Remove, and nothing is categorized without being shown.

Responsibility

Financial data is private and consequential. Destructive actions are red, never the primary button, and state their impact ("takes it off 49 transactions").

Familiarity

Use the patterns people already know from iOS: grouped lists, capsule buttons, sheets with a close control, a sidebar with tinted selection, a segmented control.

Flexibility

Light and dark follow the system setting (no in-app toggle). Increase Contrast, Reduce Transparency and Reduce Motion are honored. The layout reflows from a 1280px desktop to a 375px phone.

Simplicity

Hierarchy comes from weight, size and space, not from borders and boxes. One filled button per view; everything else is gray or plain.

Craft

Every value is a token, every token has a reason, and every reason is in this document. Tabular figures line up, hairlines are half-pixel, corners nest.

Delight

The result, not a layer on top: a glass sidebar that lets color drift beneath it, sheets that rise on a spring, a calm ledger that feels in control.

04

Color

System palette (primitives)

Apple's iOS 26 system colors. Each chip is split into light and dark. Increased-contrast twins (`-ic`) are used wherever a hue becomes text.



Red
`#ff383c` · `#ff4245`



Orange
`#ff8d28` · `#ff9230`



Yellow
`#ffcc00` · `#ffd600`



Green
`#34c759` · `#30d158`



Mint
`#00c8b3` · `#00dac3`



Teal
`#00c3d0` · `#00d2e0`



Cyan
`#00c0e8` · `#3cd3fe`



Blue
`#0088ff` · `#0091ff`



Indigo
`#6155f5` · `#6d7cff`



Purple
`#cb30e0` · `#db34f2`



Pink
`#ff2d55` · `#ff375f`



Brown
`#ac7f5e` · `#b78a66`

Semantic tokens

Token	Role	Light	Dark
`--bg-grouped`	Page background	`#f2f2f7`	`#000000`
`--bg-grouped-secondary`	Cards, lists, sections (alias --surface)	`#ffffff`	`#1c1c1e`
`--bg-elevated`	Sheets and raised surfaces (alias --surface-raised)	`#ffffff`	`#2c2c2e`
`--label-primary`	Primary text (alias --text)	`#000000`	`#ffffff`
`--label-secondary`	Secondary text; accessible opaque gray (alias --text-muted)	`#6c6c70`	`#aeaeb2`
`--label-tertiary`	Placeholders, disabled, chevrons	`rgba(60, 60, 67, 0.3)`	`rgba(235, 235, 245, 0.3)`
`--fill-tertiary`	Field, chip and gray-button fill	`rgba(120, 120, 128, 0.12)`	`rgba(120, 120, 128, 0.24)`
`--fill-quaternary`	Row hover, choice backgrounds	`rgba(120, 120, 128, 0.08)`	`rgba(120, 120, 128, 0.18)`
`--separator`	Hairlines between rows	`rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.12)`	`rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.17)`

Token	Role	Light	Dark
`--separator-opaque`	Dashed or high-contrast outlines	`#c6c6c8`	`#38383a`
`--tint-fill`	Filled buttons, selection, checkboxes (alias --accent)	`#6155f5`	`#6155f5`
`--tint-text`	Links, tinted text and icons (alias --accent-text)	`#6155f5`	`#6d7cff`
`--status-positive`	Money in, positive balances (alias --success)	`#008932`	`#30d158`
`--status-negative`	Destructive, below zero (alias --danger)	`#e9152d`	`#ff6165`

Contrast, measured

Computed from the shipped tokens (WCAG 2.x relative luminance). HIG minimum: 4.5:1 for text up to 17pt, 3:1 for 18pt+ or bold.

Pair	Light	Dark	Needs
Primary text on a card `--label-primary` on `--bg-grouped-secondary`	21.0:1	17.0:1	4.5:1
Secondary text on a card `--label-secondary` on `--bg-grouped-secondary`	5.2:1	7.7:1	4.5:1
Secondary text on the page `--label-secondary` on `--bg-grouped`	4.7:1	9.5:1	4.5:1
Tint text / links on a card `--tint-text` on `--bg-grouped-secondary`	5.1:1	4.8:1	4.5:1
White label on a filled button `--on-tint` on `--tint-fill`	5.1:1	5.1:1	4.5:1
Money in (green) on a card `--status-positive` on `--bg-grouped-secondary`	4.5:1	8.4:1	4.5:1
Negative / destructive (red) on a card `--status-negative` on `--bg-grouped-secondary`	4.6:1	5.8:1	4.5:1

Why two tints? Filled controls need a white label at ≥ 4.5:1 on the fill, while text needs the fill color at ≥ 4.5:1 on a dark card. One indigo can't do both in dark mode, so the system keeps `--tint-fill` at `#6155F5` and lifts `--tint-text` to Apple's dark indigo `#6D7CFF`.

Charts

The categorical series uses Apple hues in a fixed order (indigo, orange, teal, gold, pink, green, purple, brown). Assign them in sequence and never cycle within a chart's first eight series, so neighbouring categories stay distinguishable for common color-vision differences.



05

Typography

Figtree (display), a geometric sans close to Wealthsimple's The Future, sets titles. **Inter** (text), the open neo-grotesque nearest Wealthsimple Sans and Apple's SF Pro, sets everything else. Sizes, leading and weights are Apple's Dynamic Type "Large" defaults (17pt body, 11pt minimum). Tracking tightens as display sizes grow and stays near zero for text, following SF's tracking tables. Money uses `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums` so columns align without a monospace font.

Large Title	**34 / 41** pt/px · Bold 700 · Figtree tracking −0.02em · `--type-large-title` Page titles (h1), the net-worth hero
Title 1	**28 / 34** pt/px · Bold 700 · Figtree tracking −0.015em · `--type-title-1` Sign-in headline
Title 2	**22 / 28** pt/px · Bold 700 · Figtree tracking −0.01em · `--type-title-2` Wordmark, large section titles
Title 3	**20 / 25** pt/px · Semibold 600 · Figtree tracking −0.01em · `--type-title-3` Card and sheet titles (h2)
Headline	**17 / 22** pt/px · Semibold 600 · Inter tracking −0.01em · `--type-headline` Row titles, amounts, emphasis (h3)
Body	**17 / 22** pt/px · Regular 400 · Inter tracking −0.01em · `--type-body` Default text, fields, list rows
Callout	**16 / 21** pt/px · Regular 400 · Inter tracking −0.008em · `--type-callout` Sidebar links
Subhead	**15 / 20** pt/px · Regular 400 · Inter tracking −0.006em · `--type-subhead` Buttons, chips, menu rows, banners
Footnote	**13 / 18** pt/px · Regular 400 · Inter tracking 0 · `--type-footnote` Field labels, dates, section headers
Caption 1	**12 / 16** pt/px · Regular 400 · Inter tracking 0 · `--type-caption-1` Chips, badges, weekday labels
Caption 2	**11 / 13** pt/px · Regular 400 · Inter tracking +0.005em · `--type-caption-2` Smallest legal size (11pt minimum)

06

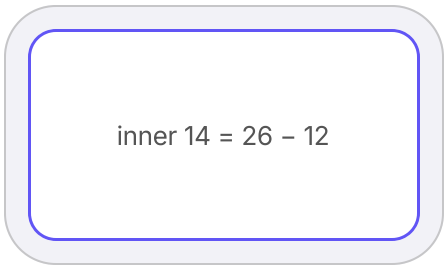
Layout, spacing & shape

4-point spacing grid

	`--space-1`	4px
	`--space-2`	8px
	`--space-3`	12px
	`--space-4`	16px
	`--space-5`	24px
	`--space-6`	32px
	`--space-7`	48px

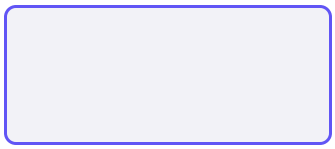
Hit targets: **44 × 44pt minimum** (`--hit-min`). Controls are 36px on desktop and grow to 44px on touch screens (`@media (pointer: coarse)`). Fields are 44px everywhere.

Concentric corners



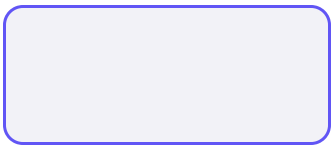
An inner radius equals the outer radius minus the padding between them, so nested shapes share a center (iOS 26). Example: the sidebar (26) with 12px padding holds links at 14.

Radius scale



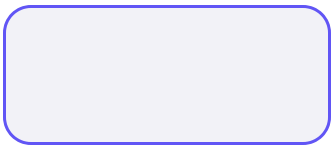
`--radius-xs`

6px · Card thumbnails



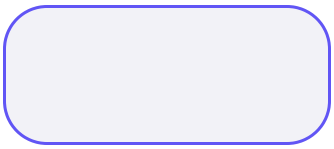
`--radius-sm`

10px · Fields, icon cells



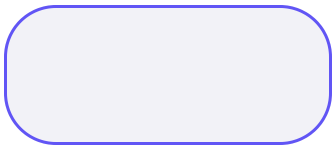
`--radius-md`

14px · List rows, menu rows, choices



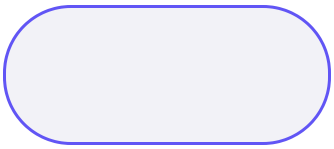
`--radius-lg`

22px · Cards, lists, menus



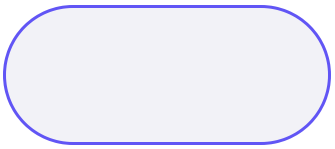
`--radius-xl`

26px · Sidebar, auth panel, dropzone



`--radius-sheet`

34px · Sheets (modals)



`--radius-full`

capsule · Buttons, chips, search, toggles

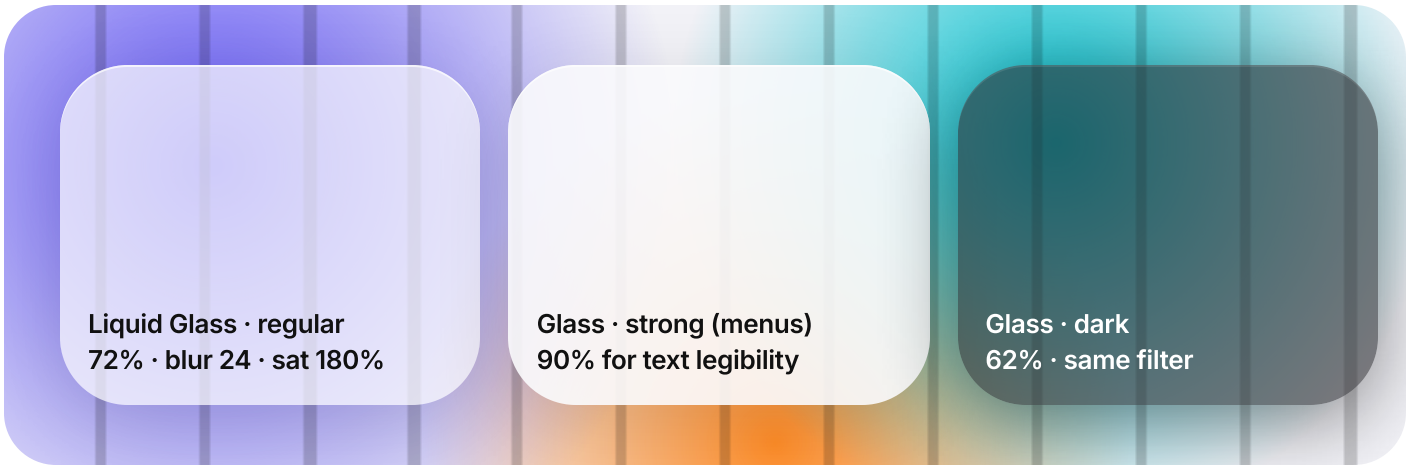
Structure

A floating sidebar (15rem) on the left, page content on the grouped background with a Large Title, cards (`.card`) for sections, and inset grouped lists for data. Below 768px the sidebar becomes a glass drawer opened from a 44pt menu button, and filter chips wrap.

07

Materials & Liquid Glass

Two families, used for different layers (HIG > Materials):



Material	Recipe (from the Figma kit)	FinAI uses it for
Liquid Glass, regular	Light: `rgba(245,245,245,.6)` over a color-dodge layer, shadow `0 8 40 rgba(0,0,0,.12)`. Dark: 67% of a `rgba(0,0,0,.6)` stack. Web: `--glass-bg` + `blur(24px) saturate(180%)` + a bright inner top edge.	Sidebar, phone drawer, back button, menu button
Glass, strong	The regular variant at ~90% opacity. The HIG says to use the regular, more opaque variant for components with a lot of text (popovers, sidebars).	Menus, pickers, calendar popovers
Standard material, regular	Light: `blur 50 + rgba(255,255,255,.6)`. Dark: `blur 50 + rgba(0,0,0,.41)`.	`--material-thin` (content-layer overlays)
Scrim	HIG: dim bright content 35% behind clear glass and modals.	Sheet backdrop, drawer backdrop

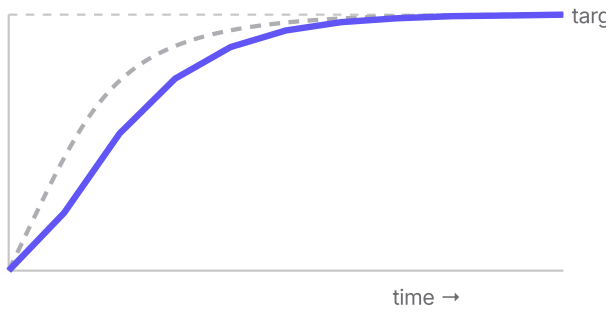
Rules. Never stack glass on glass. Never use glass for content (cards, rows, fields). With `prefers-reduced-transparency`, glass becomes the solid elevated background. With `prefers-contrast: more`, glass rises to 94–98% opacity. The phone top bar uses a scroll-edge hairline instead of a hard divider.

08

Motion

Apple's fluid-interface guidance: respond on press, keep motion brief and interruptible, and prefer springs to fixed curves. CSS can't run a live spring, so FinAI samples Apple's default UI spring (**damping 1.0, response 0.35s**, critically damped, no overshoot) into a `linear()` curve: `--spring`.

`--duration-fast`	120ms	Hover, press, color changes
`--duration-base`	250ms	Popovers, chevrons, segmented thumb
`--duration-spring`	500ms	Sheets, drawer, progress bars
`--ease-out`	cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1) for small state changes	



Indigo: `--spring` (critically damped). Gray dashed: a typical ease curve for comparison. The spring arrives fast and settles without overshoot.

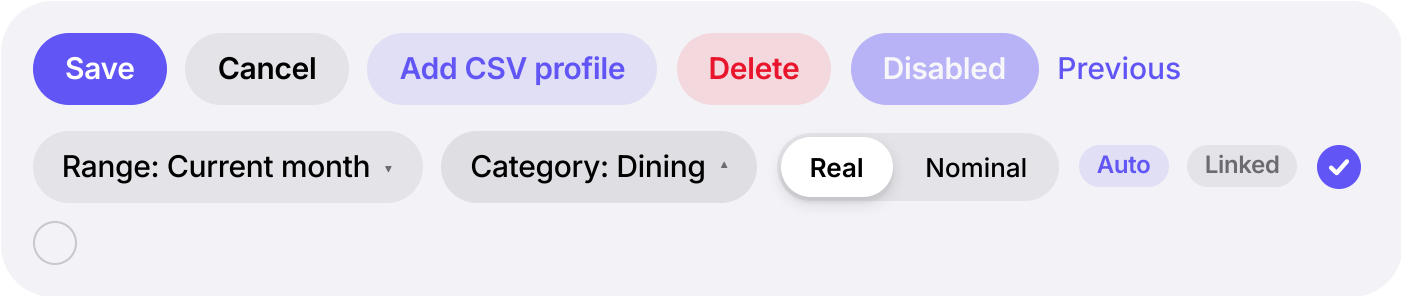
Choreography

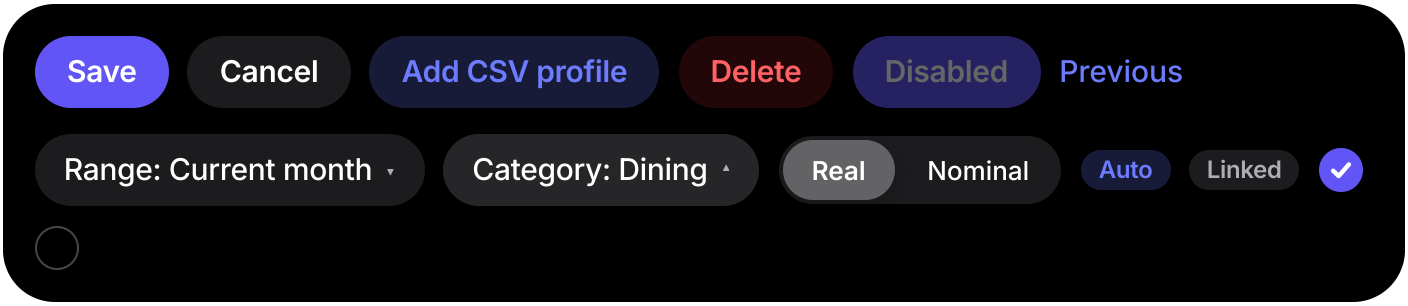
- **Press:** buttons, chips and choices scale to 0.97 on `:active`, giving feedback on pointer-down rather than on release.
- **Popovers materialize** from their trigger: scale 0.96 → 1 with a fade, transform origin at the source edge.
- **Sheets rise** 24px and fade in on `--spring`. The drawer enters and leaves along the same edge (spatial consistency).
- **Reduce Motion:** every animation and transition collapses to an instant change (`prefers-reduced-motion`), and nothing depends on motion to communicate.

09

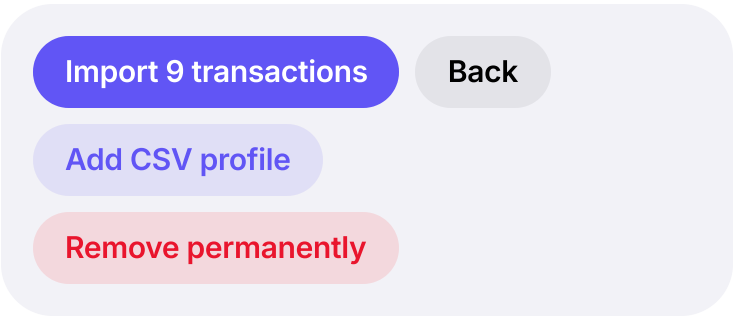
Components

Live specimens rendered by `components.css`, in light and dark.



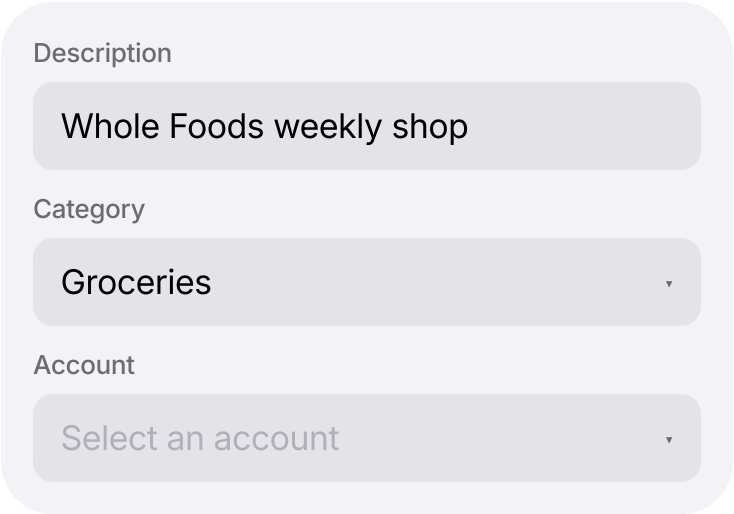


Buttons `.btn`



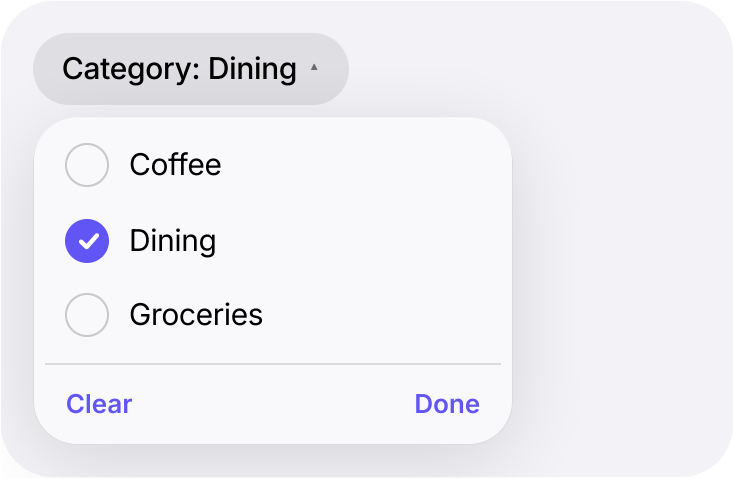
- **Filled** `.btn-primary`: the one most likely action per view (HIG: use style, not size, to rank choices).
- **Gray** `.btn-secondary`: default and Cancel. **Tinted** `.btn-tinted`: emphasis without competing with Filled.
- **Destructive** `.btn-danger`: red tint, solid red on hover. Never the primary role.
- Capsule, Subhead 15/600, 36px tall (44px on touch), press scale 0.97, disabled 40%.

Fields `input` · `.field-select` · date



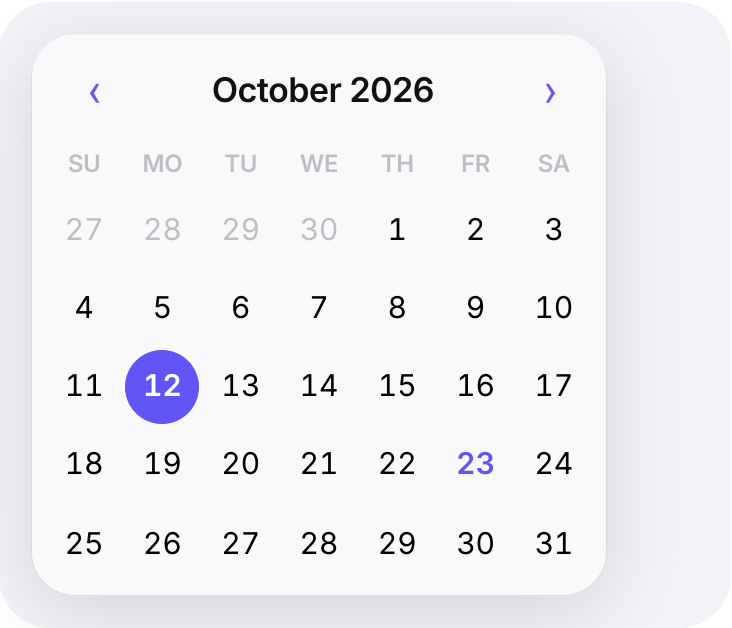
- Apple grouped-form fields: `--fill-tertiary` background, no border, 10pt corners, 44px tall, Body 17.
- Focus: the field turns to the surface color with a tint border and a 4px tint ring (`--focus-ring`).
- Labels sit above in Footnote/500, secondary label color. Placeholder text uses `--label-tertiary`.
- Select and date fields share the trigger and open glass popovers (no native controls anywhere).

Menus & filter chips `.dropdown`



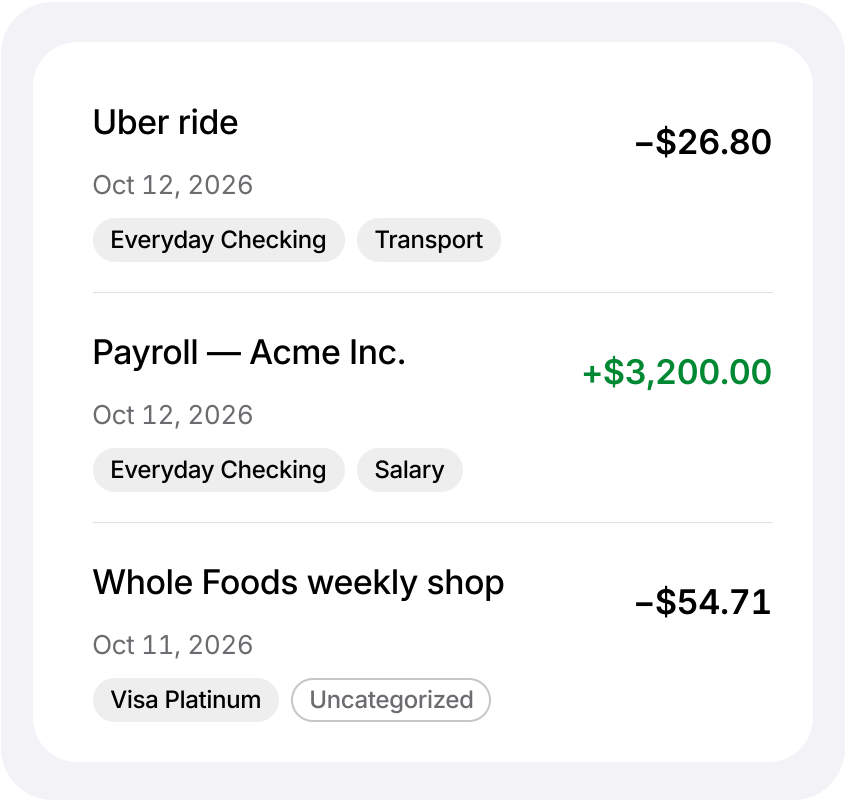
- Triggers are gray capsules (Apple's pop-up button) reading "Label: Value".
- Panels are strong-glass popovers, 22pt corners, 6px inset, rows highlighting on `--fill-tertiary` at 14pt (concentric).
- Selection uses Apple's round checkmark. Footer actions are plain tint buttons.
- Keyboard: arrows, Home/End, Enter/Space, type-ahead, Escape (closes only the menu, never the sheet around it).

Calendar `.date-panel`



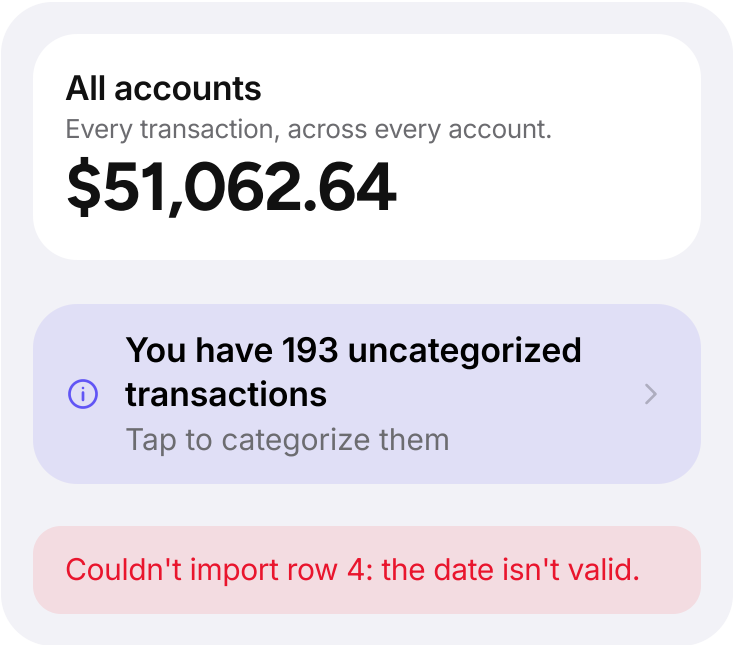
- Circular day cells, Subhead with tabular figures.
- Today: tint text, semibold. Selected: tint-filled circle with a white label.
- Weekdays in uppercase Caption, tertiary label. Days outside the month are tertiary.
- Arrows move by day or week, PageUp/PageDown by month.

Lists `.txn-list`



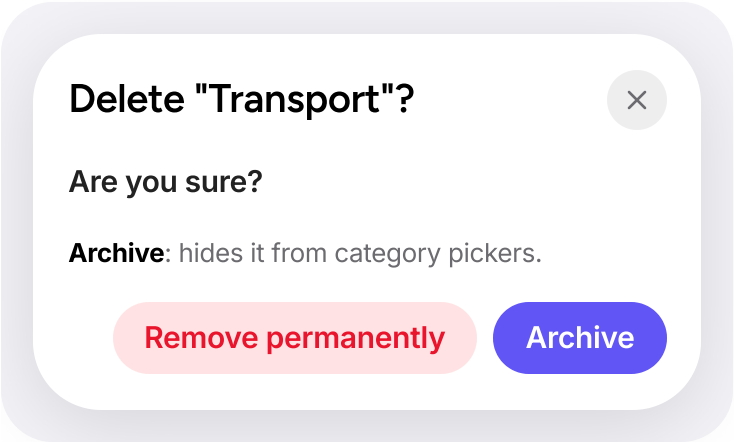
- An inset grouped list: one section with 22pt corners and rows separated by inset half-pixel hairlines. No per-row tiles.
- Row: date (Footnote, tabular), description (Body/500), chips (Caption, gray capsules), amount (Headline, tabular).
- Expense amounts use the label color; money in uses `--status-positive` with a "+".
- Uncategorized: an outlined capsule. Hover: quaternary fill. 44px minimum row height.

Cards, notices & banners



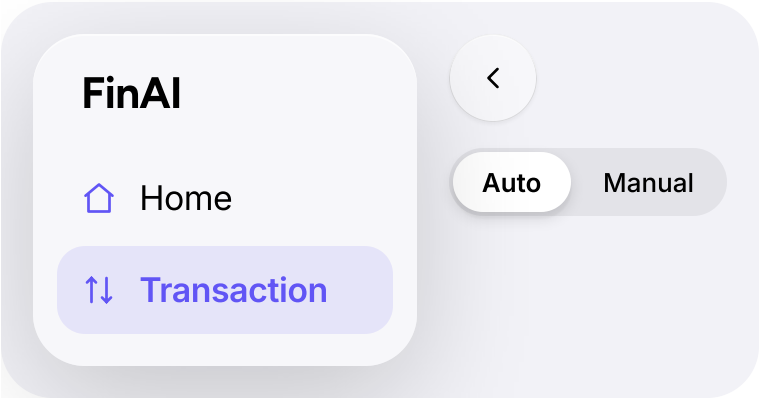
- **Card** `.card`: a grouped section with 22pt corners and no border (the background step separates it).
- **Notice** `.notice-box`: a tappable tip row with a tint-soft background, tint icon and disclosure chevron.
- **Banner** `.alert`: tinted, borderless inline status. Apple reserves modal alerts for critical, actionable moments.

Sheet `.sheet`



- Apple's sheet radius (34pt), elevated background, large shadow and a 35% scrim behind.
- Title 3 header with a 30pt gray close circle (44pt on touch).
- Primary action trailing, Cancel or destructive leading (HIG: Alerts > Buttons). Rises in on `--spring`.

Navigation: sidebar, back & segmented



- **Sidebar** `.app-rail`: floating Liquid Glass, 8px inset, 26pt corners. Links are Callout/500 with tint icons, and the selected link gets a tint-soft background.
- **Back** `.back-button`: a 44pt glass circle, the iOS 26 toolbar back button.
- **Segmented** `.segmented`: a gray capsule track with a raised thumb on the selected segment. Equal segments, noun labels, at most five on a phone.
- **Search** `.search-input`: a capsule search bar with a filled clear button (see the Transaction screenshot).

Component inventory

Component	Class / file	Apple reference
Button	`.btn` · Button.tsx	Buttons (filled / gray / tinted / destructive)
Text field	`input` · index.css	Text fields (grouped form)
Select / date / suggest	`.field-select` · FieldSelect, FieldDatePicker, SuggestInput	Pop-up buttons, date pickers
Filter chip + menu	`.dropdown` · SelectDropdown, MultiSelectDropdown, DatePickerDropdown	Menus, popovers
Checkbox	`input[type=checkbox]`	Toggles (checkmark style)
Segmented control	`.segmented` · SegmentedControl.tsx	Segmented controls
Card / section	`.card` · Card.tsx	Lists (inset grouped)
Transaction list	`.txn-list` · TransactionRow.tsx	Lists and tables
Chip / badge	`.txn-chip`, `.badge`	Tokens / labels
Notice / banner	`.notice-box`, `.alert`	Alerts (non-modal guidance)
Sheet	`.sheet` · Modal.tsx, ActionMenu.tsx	Sheets
Sidebar / drawer	`.app-rail` · AppLayout.tsx	Sidebars, tab bars
Back / icon buttons	`.back-button`, `.icon-button`	Toolbars

Accessibility

Contrast

All text pairs measured in section 04 pass 4.5:1 in light and dark. Secondary text uses Apple's accessible gray, and colored text uses the increased-contrast twins.

Increase Contrast

`prefers-contrast: more` switches separators to opaque, darkens secondary labels, moves the tint to the accessible indigo and makes glass nearly solid.

Reduce Transparency

`prefers-reduced-transparency` replaces every glass and material surface with the solid elevated background.

Reduce Motion

All transitions and animations become instant. No information is conveyed by motion alone.

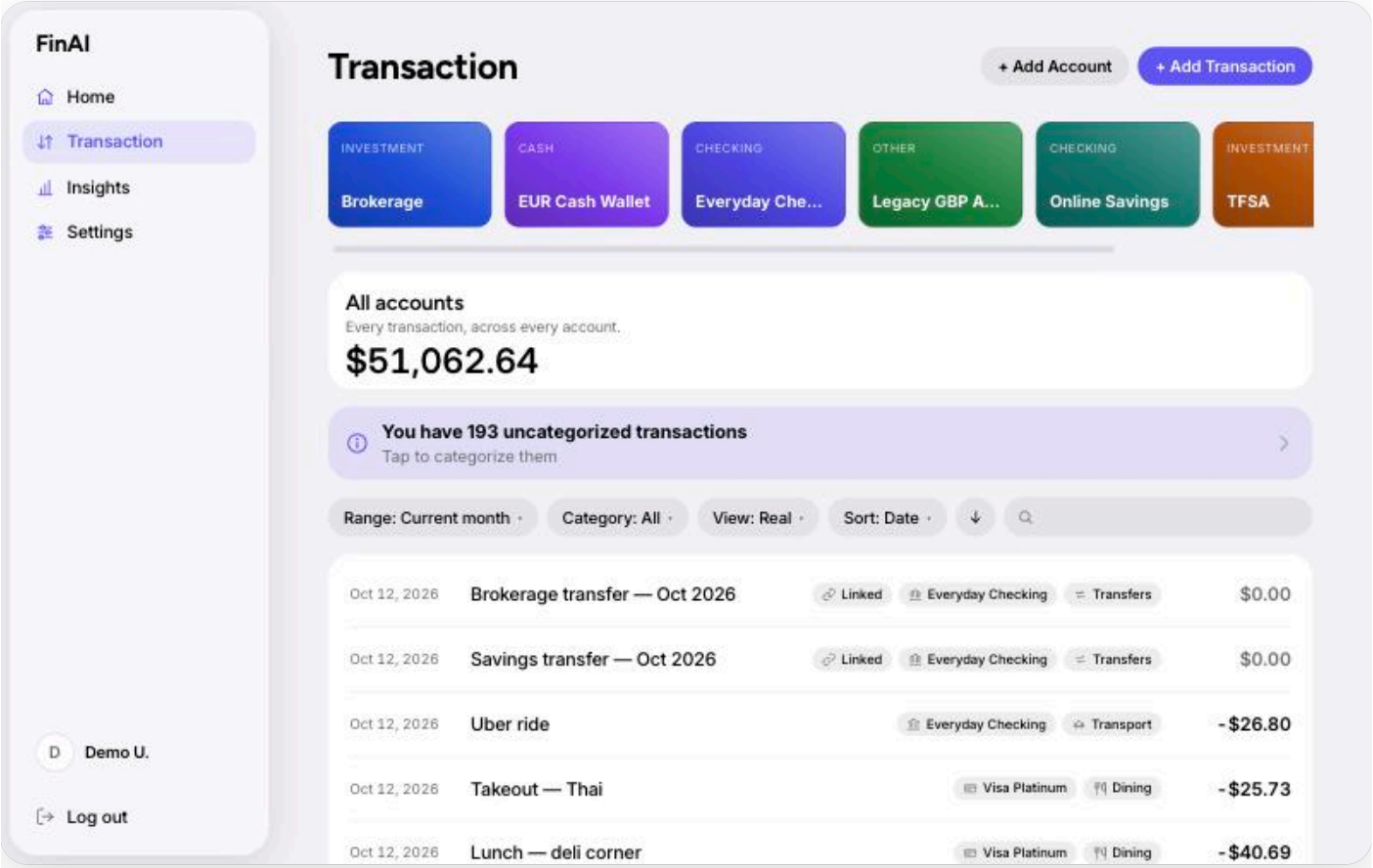
Targets & input

44pt minimum on touch. Every control is a real button or input with a visible 2px tint focus ring. Custom selects use the select-only combobox pattern with full keyboard support.

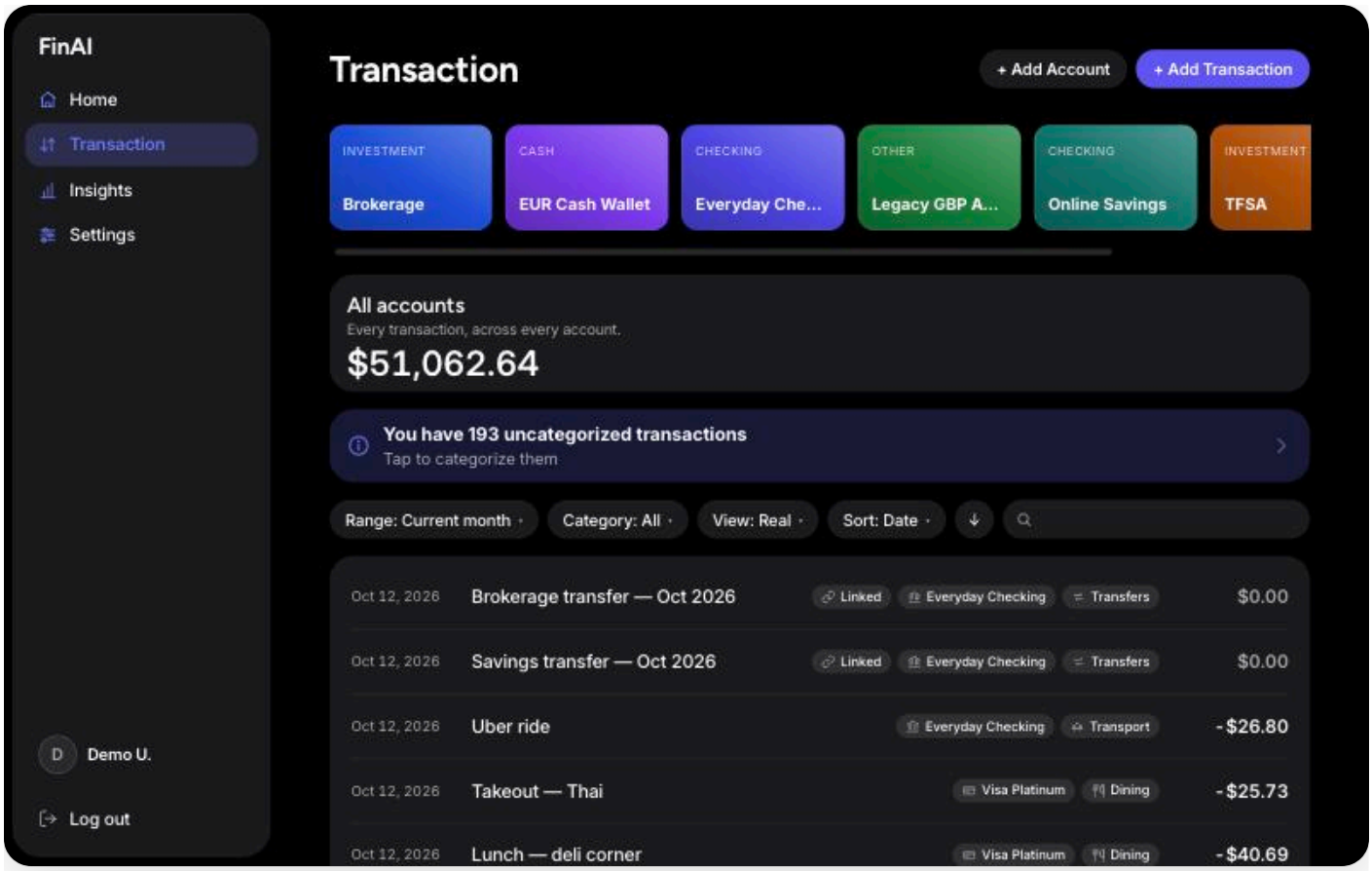
Not color alone

Amounts carry a sign, uncategorized chips are outlined (not just gray), selected states add a ring or checkmark, and destructive actions say what they'll do.

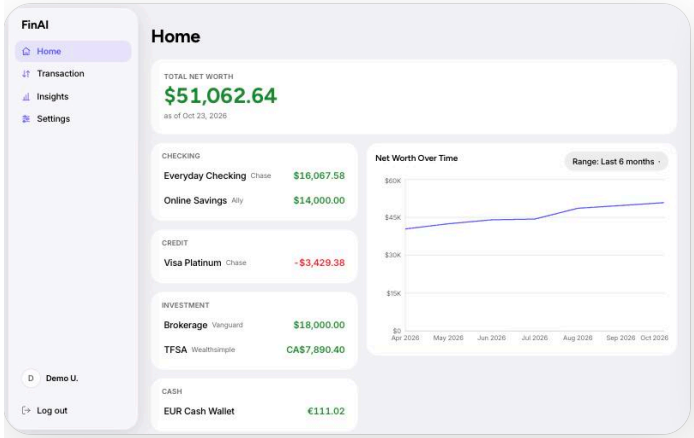
Applied to FinAI



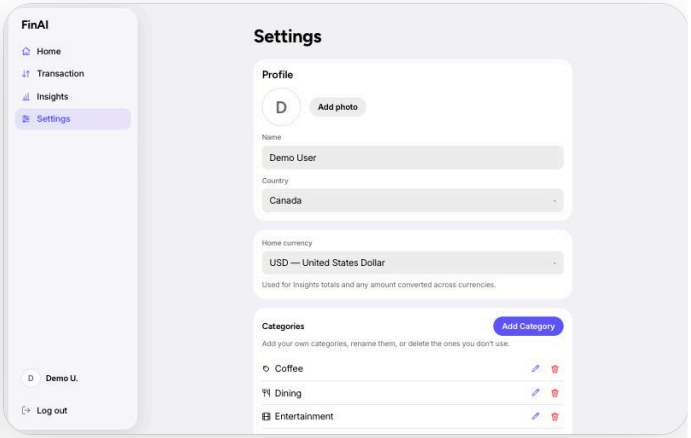
Transaction: glass sidebar with tint selection, Large Title, capsule actions, account cards, grouped summary card, tinted notice, gray filter chips and capsule search, inset grouped list with tabular amounts.



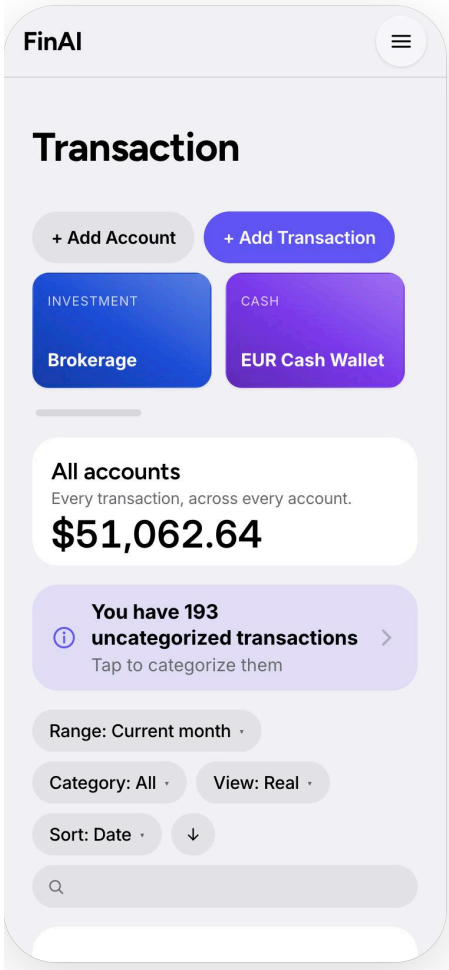
The same screen in dark mode: true-black page, #1C1C1E sections, brighter tint text, the light indigo kept for filled buttons.



Home: net-worth hero in Large Title with tabular figures, grouped account sections with Footnote headers, chart card.



Settings: grouped form cards, filled fields, a primary "Add Category" capsule, tint and destructive icon buttons.



Phone (375pt): glass menu button, wrapping chips, 44pt targets.

What changed, screen by screen

Shell	Opaque bordered rail → floating glass sidebar. Phone drawer is a glass panel on a spring. Back and menu buttons are glass circles.
Lists	Per-row tiles → one inset grouped list with hairlines. Monospace dates and amounts → tabular Inter.
Controls	8px bordered buttons → capsules in four Apple styles. Bordered fields → filled 44px fields. Square checkboxes → round checkmarks.
Overlays	Bordered modals → 34pt sheets with a scrim and a close circle. Opaque menus → glass popovers.
Color	Acid-lime accent on violet-black → systemIndigo on Apple grouped backgrounds. Coral expenses → label-colored expenses, green money in.
Type	Bricolage Grotesque + Inter at mixed sizes → Figtree + Inter on Apple's Dynamic Type scale.

Implementation & governance

Where it lives

`apps/web/src/index.css`	Token layer (primitives → semantic → aliases), dark / increased-contrast / reduced-transparency overrides, base type, form fields, checkbox.
`apps/web/src/styles/components.css`	Every component, in sections. Values reference tokens only.
`apps/web/index.html`	Figtree + Inter (Google Fonts), light and dark `theme-color`.
`Modal.tsx`, `Button.tsx`	Sheet classes instead of inline styles; the new `tinted` button variant.
`docs/design-system/`	This document (`build.py` → HTML → PDF) and the product screenshots.

Rules for contributors

- **Reference tokens, never values.** New colors go into the semantic tier with light and dark (and increased-contrast) values first.
- **Use the alias for its meaning:** `--accent` for fills, `--accent-text` for text and icons, `--text-muted` for secondary text, `--separator` for hairlines.
- **One filled button per view.** Destructive is never primary. Confirm only irreversible actions.
- **Glass only for floating controls.** Content stays on solid surfaces.
- **Native form controls are not allowed.** Use `FieldSelect`, `FieldDatePicker` and `SuggestInput` in forms, and `SelectDropdown`, `MultiSelectDropdown` and `DatePickerDropdown` in filter bars.
- **Check both appearances** and the three accessibility settings before merging. Rebuild this document when tokens change.

Known follow-ups

- The card "custom colour" swatch still opens the OS color wheel; a system color picker would complete the controls.
- Inline styles in feature screens use tokens but could move into named classes over time.
- Apple's SF Symbols can't ship on the web; the stroke icon set approximates their weight and should keep matching text weight.

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